FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-32-17009

Issue Title : Unusual Brake Pressure Readings on FDR/QAR

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	3241-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
737NG	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
05/02/2017	05/02/2017	04/21/2017

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date

Applicability

All 737MAX airplanes.

Description

Several 737NG operators have reported unusual brake pressure readings when viewing Flight Data Recorder (FDR) or Quick Access Recorder (QAR) data. The unusual pressure readings include:

1) Left brake pressures consistently higher (or lower) than right brake pressures.

2) Left or right brake pressures showing negative values when the brake pedals are released.

3) Inconsistent brake pressure readings.

Background

Some of the above observations may be normal based on tolerances of the P/N S271T451-1/-3 brake pressure transmitters. The specification for these transmitters allows up to a +/-150 psi tolerance range. This means that if one transmitter is at the low end of this range and the other transmitter is at the high end of the range, it is possible to observe up to 300 psi difference between left and right brakes. With the brake pedals released, this tolerance can also result in negative brake pressure readings.

These unusual readings have caused some 737NG operators to assume that there is a problem with the airplane's brake system.

An example of FDR data showing calibration differences between the left and right brake pressure transmitters is attached to this article. In this case, the transmitters are probably performing within specification and the calibration offset can be seen as negative pressures on the left brakes.

Boeing has also found that these pressure transmitters can drift out of calibration, resulting in a pressure reading outside of the +/-150 psi range.

In a few occasions, we have observed intermittent behavior of these transmitters. In these cases, it appears that the transmitter may temporarily stick at a certain brake pressure. Once the transmitter's internal components break free, pressures can again

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read normally.

The same transmitters are used in other applications on the 737 airplane, such as to monitor hydraulic system pressures.

Status

Closed

Interim Action

N/A

Final Action

N/A

Operator Action

Operators can perform an on-wing check of the transmitters per AMM 31-31-61. Alternatively, the transmitters can be removed from the airplane and bench tested per Honeywell CMM 29-30-03.

The transmitters do not have provisions for recalibration, so they must be discarded if they are performing outside the allowable range.

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	31-31-61		
Component Maintenance Manual (CMM)	29-30-03 (Honeywell)		

Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
Transmitter, Hydraulic Pressure	S271T451-1	Honeywell	18-2141, 18-2141-2
Transmitter, Hydraulic Pressure	S271T451-3	Honeywell	18-2141-3

Related Categories

- Component Issues : Issues that occur during component maintenance or have an impact on component reliability

Attachments:

a) Example Brake Pressures from FDR

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